Project: Worked examples
Title: Pipe expansion, loops and anchor forces (screening)
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1. Scope and method

Screening only — not a piping stress analysis. Thermal growth of a straight run between anchors, the fully restrained stress and force, the leg an offset leg or a U-loop (two guided cantilevers) needs to absorb the growth within the owner's allowable displacement-stress range Sa and whether the available leg is long enough (an offset leg or Z-bend also loads its run or runs with the leg's own growth), the force on the anchors and the largest root moment of the guided-cantilever model, the screening ratio $D \cdot Y/(L - U)^2$ against the owner's K1 (PASS, or the line needs a formal stress analysis), and, for an axial bellows, the anchor force P·A_eff plus its spring force. No allowable stress, K1 or code table ships.

WHAT IT CALCULATES	RELATION
Pipe section	$d_i = OD - 2 \cdot t$; $A_m = \pi/4 \cdot (OD^2 - d_i^2)$; $I = \pi/64 \cdot (OD^4 - d_i^4)$; $Z = I/(OD/2)$
Temperature change	$\Delta T = T_{operate} - T_{install}$, or as entered; the movement uses $\lvert\Delta T\rvert$ and its sign gives the direction
Run that grows	$L_{tot} = L$, or $L + L2$ for a Z-bend; thermal growth $\Delta L = \alpha \cdot L_{tot} \cdot \lvert\Delta T\rvert$
Fully restrained pipe	$\sigma_r = E \cdot \alpha \cdot \lvert\Delta T\rvert$ (E at the installation temperature); $F_r = E_r \cdot \alpha \cdot \lvert\Delta T\rvert \cdot A_m$ ($E_r = E_{hot}$, else E)
Movement one leg must absorb	$\Delta = \Delta L$ for an offset leg or Z-bend; $\Delta = \Delta L/2$ for a U-loop (two identical legs in series, the cross leg a rigid guide)
Guided cantilever, required leg	$L_{req} = \sqrt{(3 \cdot E \cdot OD \cdot \Delta/Sa)}$, the leg at which the bending stress M/Z reaches Sa; PASS when $L_{req} \le$ the available leg H
Force and moment of the available leg	$F_{leg} = 12 \cdot E_r \cdot I \cdot \Delta/H^3$ (acts along the run); $M_{leg} = 6 \cdot E_r \cdot I \cdot \Delta/H^2$ ($= F_{leg} \cdot H/2$); $\sigma_{leg} = 3 \cdot E \cdot OD \cdot \Delta/H^2 = Sa \cdot (L_{req}/H)^2$
Offset leg or Z-bend, the runs bend for the leg's growth $\Delta_{leg} = \alpha \cdot \lvert\Delta T\rvert \cdot H$	the runs act in series under one force $F_{run} = 12 \cdot E_r \cdot I \cdot \Delta_{leg}/(L^3 + L2^3)$ ($L2 = 0$ for an L-bend) acting along the leg; run i takes the share $L_i^3/(L^3 + L2^3)$ of Δ_{leg}, with root stress $\sigma_i = 3 \cdot E \cdot OD \cdot \Delta_i/L_i^2$ and moment $M_i = F_{run} \cdot L_i/2$; each run is checked as its own cantilever, PASS when $\sqrt{(\sigma_i/Sa)} \le 1$ (for an L-bend the run needed is $L_{req,run} = \sqrt{(3 \cdot E \cdot OD \cdot \Delta_{leg}/Sa)}$)
Force on the anchors	the two components are perpendicular, F_{leg} along the run and F_{run} along the leg, so the force is $\sqrt{(F_{leg}^2 + F_{run}^2)}$; the moment reported is the largest root moment of the legs and runs in the guided-cantilever model
Flexibility screening	$OD \cdot Y/(L_{dev} - U)^2 \le K1$ with $Y = \alpha \cdot \lvert\Delta T\rvert \cdot U$, the free growth between the anchors; offset leg or Z-bend $L_{dev} = L_{tot} + H$, $U = \sqrt{(L_{tot}^2 + H^2)}$; U-loop $L_{dev} = L + 2 \cdot H$, $U = L$ (so $Y = \Delta L$); PASS, or the line needs a formal stress analysis

WHAT IT CALCULATES	RELATION
Axial bellows (no leg or loop, no leg check, no screening)	anchor force = $P \cdot A_{eff} + k \cdot \Delta L$; the movement is checked against the bellows' rated axial movement when given

Basis: Process piping — flexibility analysis, exemption from formal analysis[1](para. 319.4.1 (screening relation; number to be checked against the owner's copy)); Process piping — displacement stress range and reactions[1](para. 319.3.2 and 319.5 (reference and hot moduli; numbers to be checked against the owner's copy)); Metallic industrial piping — flexibility analysis[2](cl. 12 (number to be checked against the owner's copy)).

2. Inputs

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
E	Young's modulus of the pipe material at the installation (reference) temperature, for the stress check, in GPa (steel 210, copper 120, PE and PP about 1; not MPa)	120	GPa	assumption: W3 seed 'Copper (generic)', indicative; replace with the project's material record.	0.5 ... 500 GPa
α	Mean coefficient of thermal expansion between the install and operating temperatures	17	um/(m·K)	assumption: W3 seed 'Copper (generic)' (17e-6 1/K), indicative; replace with the project's material record.	1 ... 250 um/(m·K)
OD	Pipe outside diameter	54	mm	drawing: DRG-M-212 rev B	10 ... 1500 mm
t_{wall}	Pipe wall thickness	1.5	mm	drawing: DRG-M-212 rev B	0.5 ... 60 mm
L	Anchor spacing: the straight length that grows (an offset leg or Z-bend: the first run, which also bends for the leg's growth)	24	m	drawing: DRG-M-212 rev B	1 ... 500 m
$temp_{mode}$	Temperature change from	install and operating temperatures		assumption: Install and operating temperatures are both known.	any
$T_{install}$	Temperature at installation (when the run is anchored)	10	°C	assumption: Mean site temperature when the riser is anchored.	-50 ... 50 °C
$T_{operate}$	Operating temperature (hot or cold)	70	°C	spec: SPEC-M-04 §3: heating flow temperature	-50 ... 500 °C

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
layout	What absorbs the movement	axial bellows (no leg or loop: the bellows absorbs the movement)		drawing: DRG-M-212 rev B	any
P_b	Axial bellows governing pressure, gauge, at or above zero: the design or test pressure that governs the anchor sizing (a vacuum bellows is outside this sheet; compression and extension ratings can differ, enter the governing one)	6	bar	spec: Heating circuit design pressure, gauge	0.1 … 40 bar
A_{eff}	Axial bellows effective area A_{eff} (manufacturer's data)	40	cm²	assumption: Placeholder effective area; replace with the manufacturer's datasheet value.	1 … 5000 cm²
k_b	Axial bellows spring rate (manufacturer's data; blank = no spring force)	80	N/mm	assumption: Placeholder spring rate; replace with the manufacturer's datasheet value.	1 … 5000 N/mm
dL_{rated}	Rated axial movement of the bellows (manufacturer's data; blank = movement not checked)	40	mm	assumption: Placeholder rated axial movement; replace with the manufacturer's datasheet value.	1 … 500 mm

3. Assumptions

A1. Screening only — not a piping stress analysis. The result tells whether a simple leg or loop is plausible and what it puts on its anchors; it does not replace a flexibility analysis of the real routing (elbow flexibility, intensification, torsion, branches, restraint friction, supports, sustained and occasional loads). (Stated scope.)
A2. A guided cantilever: the available leg is straight, uniform, fixed against rotation at both ends and loaded only by the movement it absorbs (stiffness $12 \cdot E \cdot I / H^3$, end moment $F \cdot H / 2$). Elbows are taken as rigid and the leg as slender: the beam model is not valid for legs shorter than about ten diameters. (Beam theory.)
A3. No stress-intensification factor and no elbow flexibility are applied: the stress at the elbow root of a real bend is higher than the beam stress M/Z, by the intensification factor of the code, so a leg that passes here can still exceed Sa at the elbow. This is the main reason the result is a screen and not a stress analysis. (Stated limit.)
A4. A U-loop is two identical legs in series, each a guided cantilever taking half the growth, the cross leg a rigid guide; the force along the line is the same F in both legs. The moment M is the moment at the leg

roots (the corners of the loop); it reaches an anchor only where the leg ends at the anchor (an offset leg). The growth of the loop's own legs, which the cross leg has to absorb, is not checked. (Loop model.)
A5. An offset leg is anchored at both ends: the run L bends for the growth of the leg ($\alpha \cdot |\Delta T| \cdot H$) as a second guided cantilever and is checked against the same Sa. A Z-bend (second run L2) has the two runs in series under one force, each taking its share of the leg's growth in proportion to its flexibility, L_i^3, and each checked as its own cantilever; the leg takes the growth of both runs. The force on the anchors is the resultant of the force along the run (the leg's) and the force along the leg (the runs'), which are perpendicular. (Offset-leg and Z-bend model.)
A6. $anchor_{moment}$ is the largest root moment of the legs and runs in the guided-cantilever simplification ($M = F \cdot L/2$ with each end fixed against rotation). It is not the moment on a frame anchor, which depends on the whole frame (the stiffness of the other legs, the elbow rotations, the anchor's own fixity); a formal analysis is needed before an anchor is sized for moment. (Stated limit.)
A7. The material properties are single values: α the mean coefficient between the install and operating temperatures; E the modulus at the installation (reference) temperature, used for the stress check, as the piping codes do (ASME B31.3 para. 319.3.2 and 319.5, numbers to be checked against the owner's copy); E_{hot}, when given, is used only for the reactions on the anchors. Take them from a W3 material applied at the right temperature. (Material library; code convention to be checked.)
A8. Sa and K1 are the owner's records from the owner's own copy of the piping code (or the design basis), with their provenance; no allowable stress, K1 or code constant ships. The sheet applies the relation to the numbers entered and does not know which code, material or load case they belong to. (No table from a standard is shipped.)
A9. No friction, weight, spring-hanger or cold-spring effect is included in the leg force. The axial bellows anchor force is the pressure thrust $P \cdot A_{eff}$ plus the spring force $k \cdot \Delta L$ at the governing pressure entered (the design or the test pressure, whichever governs; a bellows' compression and extension ratings can differ): guide friction and any other bellows load come from the manufacturer's data. (Stated limit.)
A10. E (Young's modulus of the pipe material at the installation (reference) temperature, for the stress check, in GPa (steel 210, copper 120, PE and PP about 1; not MPa)) is taken as 120 GPa. (W3 seed 'Copper (generic)', indicative; replace with the project's material record.)
A11. α (Mean coefficient of thermal expansion between the install and operating temperatures) is taken as 17 um/(m*K). (W3 seed 'Copper (generic)' (17e-6 1/K), indicative; replace with the project's material record.)
A12. $temp_{mode}$ (Temperature change from) is taken as install and operating temperatures. (Install and operating temperatures are both known.)
A13. $T_{install}$ (Temperature at installation (when the run is anchored)) is taken as 10 degC. (Mean site temperature when the riser is anchored.)
A14. A_{eff} (Axial bellows effective area A_{eff} (manufacturer's data)) is taken as 40 cm^2. (Placeholder effective area; replace with the manufacturer's datasheet value.)
A15. k_b (Axial bellows spring rate (manufacturer's data; blank = no spring force)) is taken as 80 N/mm. (Placeholder spring rate; replace with the manufacturer's datasheet value.)
A16. dL_{rated} (Rated axial movement of the bellows (manufacturer's data; blank = movement not checked)) is taken as 40 mm. (Placeholder rated axial movement; replace with the manufacturer's datasheet value.)
A17. Layout: an axial bellows absorbs the whole movement of 24.48 mm; there is no leg check and no screening. The anchors take the pressure thrust $P \cdot A_{eff}$ plus the spring force $k \cdot \Delta L$; guide friction, lateral and angular movement and the bellows' own limits are the manufacturer's. Screening only — not a piping stress analysis. (Bellows layout.)

4. Working

[9] $dT = T_{operate} - T_{install}$
$= 70\ degC - 10\ degC$
$= 60\ K$
Temperature change, operating – install

[11] $E_r = E$
= 120 GPa
= 120 GPa
Modulus for the reactions (E, no E_{hot} given)
[12] $D_i = OD - 2 * t_{wall}$
= 54 mm − 2 × 1.5 mm
= 51 mm
Inside diameter
[13] $A_m = pi / 4 * (OD^2 - D_i^2)$
= π / 4 × ((54 mm)^2 − (51 mm)^2)
= 247.4 mm²
Metal cross-section
[14] $I_x = pi / 64 * (OD^4 - D_i^4)$
= π / 64 × ((54 mm)^4 − (51 mm)^4)
= 8.5307 cm⁴
Second moment of area of the pipe section
[15] $Z_x = I_x / (OD / 2)$
= 8.5307 cm⁴ / (54 mm / 2)
= 3.1595 cm³
Section modulus
[16] $L_{tot} = L$
= 24 m
= 24 m
Length that grows between the anchors
[17] $dL = \alpha * L_{tot} * abs(dT)$
= 17 um/(m·K) × 24 m × abs(60 K)
= 24.48 mm
Thermal growth between the anchors, as a magnitude
[18] $dL_{signed} = \alpha * L_{tot} * dT$
= 17 um/(m·K) × 24 m × 60 K
= 24.48 mm
Thermal movement with its sign: positive lengthens, negative shortens
[19] $\sigma_{res} = E * \alpha * abs(dT)$
= 120 GPa × 17 um/(m·K) × abs(60 K)
= 122.4 MPa
Stress in the fully restrained pipe (E at the installation temperature)
[20] $F_{res} = E_r * \alpha * abs(dT) * A_m$
= 120 GPa × 17 um/(m·K) × abs(60 K) × 247.4 mm²
= 30.282 kN
Force on the anchors of the fully restrained pipe
[23] $F_{thrust} = P_b * A_{eff}$
= 6 bar × 40 cm²
= 2.4 kN
Bellows pressure thrust on the anchors, at the governing (design or test) pressure
[25] $F_{spring} = k_b * dL$
= 80 N/mm × 24.48 mm
= 1958.4 N
Bellows spring force at the full movement
[26] $anchor_{force} = F_{thrust} + F_{spring}$
= 2.4 kN + 1958.4 N
= 4358.4 N
Force on the anchors: pressure thrust plus spring force

[27] $anchor_{moment}$ = axial bellows: no bending
= the movement is axial
= 0 N·m
Moment at the anchors: none from an axial bellows
[29] $u_{bellows}$ = dL / dL_{rated}
= 24.48 mm / 40 mm
= 0.612
Movement over the bellows' rated axial movement
[30] pass = the rated movement is given and met
= 1 check(s)
= 1
1 when the movement is within the bellows' rated axial movement; 0 when it is not or when no rating was entered

5. Results

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
D_i	51 mm	Inside diameter
A_m	247.4 mm²	Metal cross-section
I_x	8.5307 cm⁴	Second moment of area
Z_x	3.1595 cm³	Section modulus
dT	60 K	Temperature change
L_{tot}	24 m	Length that grows
dL	24.48 mm	Thermal movement between the anchors (magnitude)
dL_{signed}	24.48 mm	Thermal movement, signed
σ_{res}	122.4 MPa	Fully restrained stress
F_{res}	30.282 kN	Fully restrained force
direction	"growth: the pipe lengthens; fully restrained it presses on its anchors (compression)"	Direction of the movement
F_{thrust}	2.4 kN	Bellows pressure thrust
$anchor_{force}$	4358.4 N	Force on the anchors
$anchor_{moment}$	0 N·m	Moment at the anchors
F_{spring}	1958.4 N	Bellows spring force
$u_{bellows}$	0.612	Movement over the rated movement
screen	"not applicable: the bellows absorbs the movement"	Screening result
pass	1	All checks pass

6. Checks (governing first)

RESULT	CHECK	DEMAND	CAPACITY	UTILISATION	REF

RESULT	CHECK	DEMAND	CAPACITY	UTILISATION	REF
PASS	Movement against the rated axial movement of the bellows (40 mm)	$u_{bellows} = 0.612$	$u_{bellows} \le 1$	0.612	

7. Applicability

WARNING — record: Tabulated values not taken from a reference record: E, α (Material properties); OD, t_{wall} (Pipe outside diameter and wall); A_{eff}, k_b, dL_{rated} (Axial bellows data). Enter each as one so its source, edition and licence travel with it.

8. Verification

Template bs.pipe-expansion@1.2.2 Content hash 831557e4db478bd5 Engine calc-engine/1.0.0
Known-answer cases passed 5/5 Test run 2026-10-23 12:00 UTC TempestOS 0.26.0

9. References

1. ASME B31.3.
2. EN 13480-3.